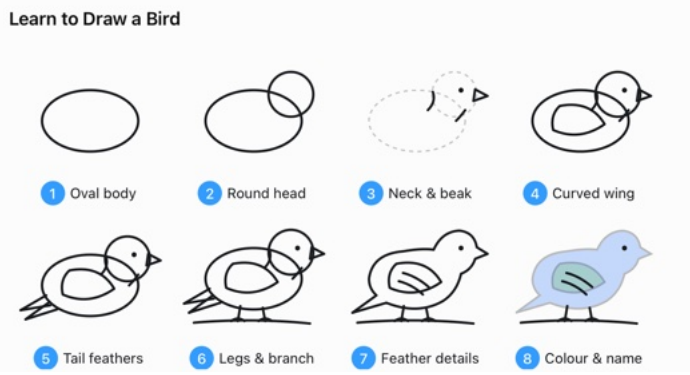
**1st Midrand Scout Group**
**Sandton District, Gauteng Region**

| 1st Midrand Cub Programme Planning Document | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Programme Name:** | *Feathered Friends* | **Programme Writer:** | Akela | **Duty Six:** | Red |
| **Programme Date:** | 15 August 2026 | **Programme Run By:** | Bagheera | **Special Helper:** | - |
| **Programme Time:** | 08:00 – 09:30 | **Adult Leaders:** | Bagheera, Chil | **Cub Prayer:** | |
| | | | | **Tea:** | - |
| **NC = National Challenge; SW = Silver Wolf; GW = Gold Wolf; LW = Leaping Wolf; IB = Interest Badge; * = bones earned** | | | | | |

| Time | Duration | Activity | Equipment | Person Responsible | Rationale / Advancement |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 07:45 | 00:15 | Arrival, set up for Grand Howl | Cones / Tape to mark off parking area. | Adult leaders<br>Duty six<br>Special helper | SW-25 |
| 08:00 | 00:10 | Allocate new chums<br>Grand howl<br>Roll Call<br>Inspection – Paws and Claws | Flag<br>Totem<br>Skin<br>Bones | Adult leaders<br>Duty six | SW-72 |
| *"The birds of the jungle are disappearing—or perhaps everyone has simply stopped noticing them! Bagheera and Chil have called together a team of young jungle naturalists. Your mission is to sharpen your eyes, train your ears and discover which feathered friends share our country."* | | | | | |
| *"Before we can begin our birdwatch, the sparrows must make it safely across the jungle clearing—but hungry hawks are circling overhead, ready to swoop!"* | | | | | |
| 08:10 | 00:10 | **Steam Release Game: Hawks and Sparrows**<br>1. Mark two safe "nests" approximately 15–20 metres apart. Choose two Cubs as hawks in the middle.<br>2. The remaining Cubs are sparrows and begin in one nest.<br>3. On **"Sparrows, leave your nests!"**, they run to the opposite nest without being tagged.<br>4. Tagged sparrows freeze with their arms stretched out like wings.<br>5. A free sparrow can rescue them by touching one wing and naming a bird that has not already been used during that crossing. | Cones or markers for "nests" | Chil | Steam release game. |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | 6. Hawks may tag gently but may not enter the nests or tag Cubs during a rescue.<br>7. Repeat in the opposite direction and change the hawks after two or three crossings. | | | |
| *"Now that the sparrows have escaped the hawks, it is time to become Bird Detectives—using clues about each bird's appearance, behaviour, habitat and call to identify some of South Africa's feathered friends."* | | | | | |
| 08:20 | 00:15 | **Bird Detectives**<br>Read the clues for each bird one at a time, beginning with the most difficult. Cubs may raise their hands as soon as they think they know the answer, but may make only one guess per clue. The first Cub to identify the bird correctly earns a bone for their Six. If nobody identifies it from the verbal clues, reveal the bird's picture as the final clue. Briefly discuss its appearance, habitat, food and behaviour before moving to the next bird. | *Clue Cards*<br>*Pictures of Birds* | Bagheera<br>Chil | Birds Badge - 1 |
| *"Bird Detectives do not rely only on their eyes—sometimes a bird is hidden high in a tree, so we must listen as carefully as an owl to identify it by its call."* | | | | | |
| 08:35 | 00:10 | **Listen Like an Owl**<br>Prepare short recordings of these three distinctive bird calls:<br>1. Hadeda ibis<br>2. Laughing dove<br>3. Grey go-away-bird<br>Play each recording loudly enough for the whole Pack to hear, but keep the phone screen hidden.<br>**Instructions**<br>1. Gather the Cubs quietly and ask them to close their eyes.<br>2. Introduce each bird by playing its call and then revealing its name and picture.<br>3. Replay all three calls in a different order.<br>4. Cubs raise their hands when they recognise a call.<br>5. The first Cub to identify it correctly earns a bone for their Six.<br>6. Finish with a memory round by playing all three calls consecutively. The first Six to give the complete correct order earns a bonus bone.<br>Remind the Cubs that they must listen silently until the recording has finished and may make only one guess per call. | Phone and portable speaker<br>Three downloaded bird-call recordings<br>Pictures of the three birds | Bagheera<br>Chil | Birds Badge - 2 |
| *"Let's test whether our Bird Detectives can think as quickly as a bird can flap its wings!"* | | | | | |
| 08:45 | 00:10 | **Game: Birds Fly**<br>1. Cubs spread out facing the leader.<br>2. The leader calls the name of an animal while flapping their arms and saying, for example, "Hadedas fly!"<br>3. If the named animal can fly, the Cubs flap their wings. | | | Game |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | 4. If it cannot fly, they must remain completely still—even if the leader flaps.<br>5. A Cub who moves incorrectly performs a fun action, such as three "chick hops", before rejoining.<br>6. Gradually increase the speed and mix birds with animals such as bats, butterflies, elephants, penguins and ostriches.<br>7. Allow individual Cubs to take turns as the caller.<br>For the final round, use only birds and test whether the Cubs remember which birds are flightless. | | | |
| *"Birdwatchers often draw the birds they see, recording their shape, colours and special features—so let's learn how to create our own field-guide drawing."* | | | | | |
| 08:55 | 25:00 | **Learn to Draw a Bird**<br>1. Draw a large oval for the body.<br>2. Add a smaller circle for the head.<br>3. Join the head and body with two curved lines.<br>4. Add a triangle or curved shape for the beak.<br>5. Draw an almond-shaped wing on the body.<br>6. Add the tail using three long feather shapes.<br>7. Draw two legs with toes gripping a branch.<br>8. Add the eye and feather markings.<br>9. Choose a local bird and colour the drawing to match its photograph.<br>10. Write the bird's name beneath the picture.<br>  | A4 paper<br>Pencils and erasers<br>Colouring pencils or crayons<br>A large example drawing or whiteboard<br>Pictures of local birds for reference | Bagheera<br>Chil | Birds Badge - 4 |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | |
| 09:20 | | Badges<br>Announcements<br>Closing<br>Cub prayer | Badges<br>Bone stack | | |
| 09:30 | | Sixer boxes tidy up | | Sixers | |
| | | Tidy up | | Duty six | |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | Adult meeting and debrief | | Adult leaders | |

| Activities to complete at home | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| - | - | | | | |